[49] Oral evidence of S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, IMMC, evidence volume, p. 626.

[50] Ibid., p. 629.

[51] IMMC, report, pp. 19–20.

[52] Oral evidence of S.D. Krishna Aiyangar, IMMC, evidence volume, p. 628.

[53] See the exchange in ibid., pp. 626, 629.

[54] For his generous support to the first Tamil encyclopaedia, *Abhithana Chintamani* see Venkatachalapathy, *Brief History of a Very Big Book*, pp. 12–17.

[55] MPAI, 1908, para 1138(c). Ideological bonding was something that was beyond the comprehension of the secret police.

[56] Letter no. 886, Public (Confidential), 26-9-1910. Marginal note dated 24-8-1910 by A. Butterworth (secretary to GoM).

[57] MPAI, 1908, para 1138(c).

[58] Hardgrave, *Nadars of Tamilnad* remains the standard work on the rise of the Nadars.

[59] These fragmentary details about Maya Nadar come from his great grandson/grandnephew K. Nirmalavel. Maya Nadar's younger brother, M.V. Shamugavel was the founder chairman of the Nadar Bank which later became the Tamilnadu Mercantile Bank.

[60] Evidence of D. Diravia Nadar, IOL: L/P&J/6/857.

[61] Evidence of Sankaralinga Nadar, IOL: L/P&J/6/857. VOC too refers to this encounter in one of his speeches: MPAI, 1908, 330(a).

[62] MPAI, 1907, para 133(b).

[63] See VOC's letter in *The Hindu*, 26-11-1906.

[64] MPAI, 1907, para 133(b).

[65] *The Hindu*, 30-5-1908.

[66] *Swadesamitran*, 31-3-1908; *The Hindu*, 1-4-1908.

[67] Rajmohan Gandhi, *Rajaji Story*, vol. 1, p. 21. The relevant reference cites R.V. Krishna Iyer's essay on Rajaji in *Kalki*, 8-12-1957. However, it does not contain this information, probably a misplaced reference. The contribution of Rajaji is not in doubt.